

Republic Disguised as Democracy

The Oligarchic Structure of Parliamentarism

From electoral permission to citizen sovereignty

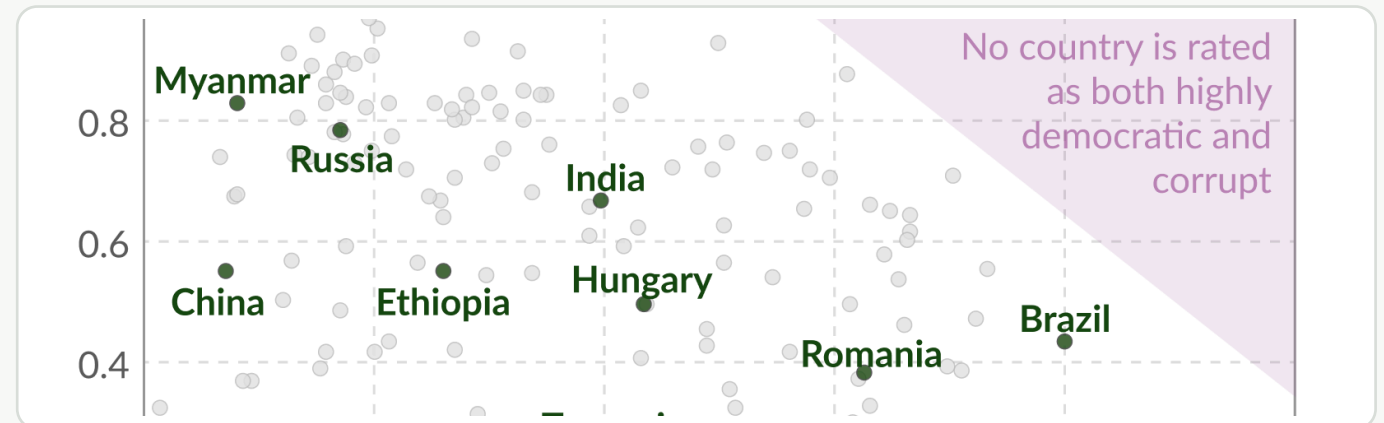


The Core Deception

- Elections without rule
- Representation without mandate
- Public interest defined from above
- Citizens as spectators
- Oligarchy with democratic branding

1 vote

Political equality is necessary, not sufficient



Argument 1 · Elections Are Not Rule

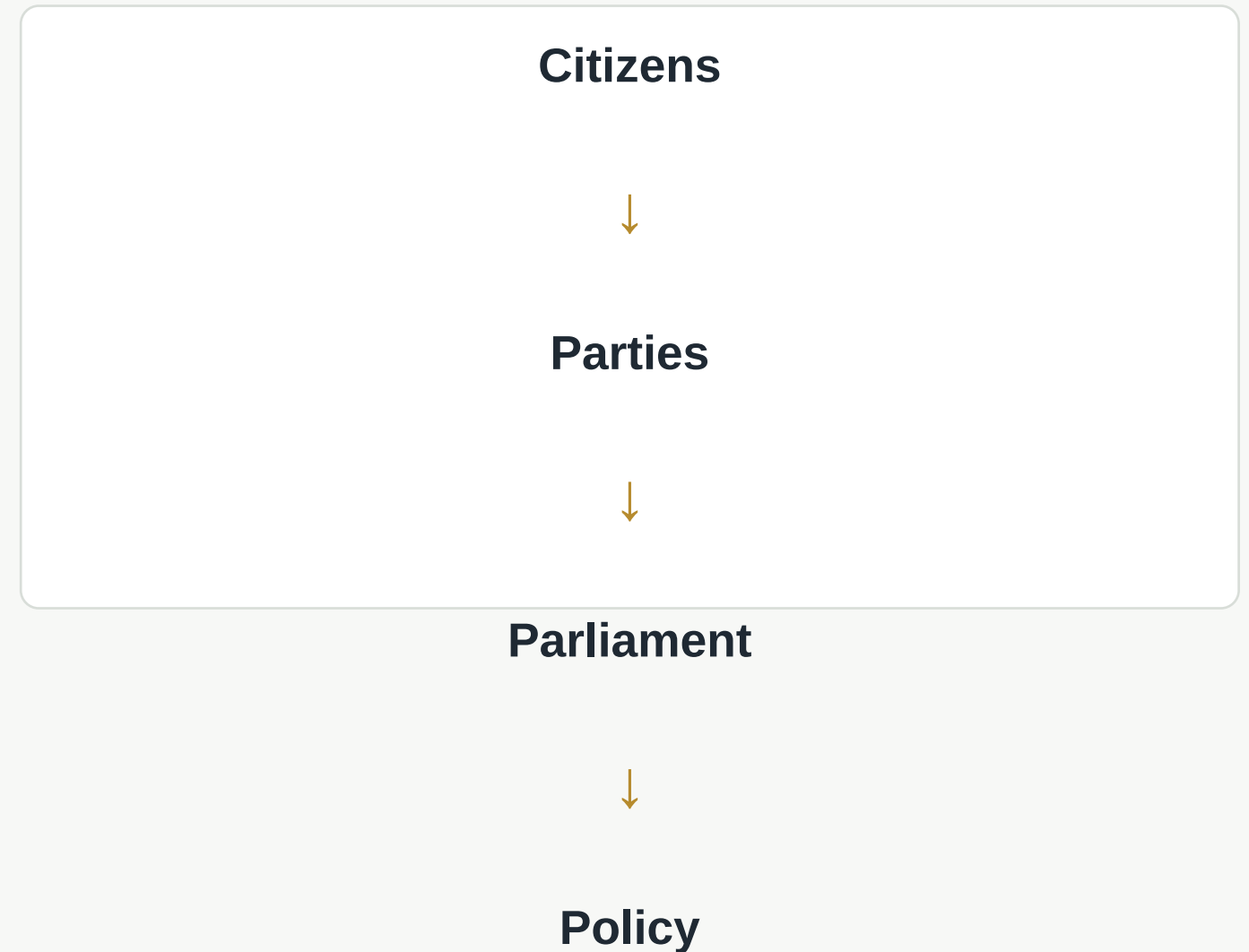
- Res publica
- Managed public interest
- Officeholder interpretation
- No citizen agenda-setting
- No continuous sovereignty



Aristotle · Rousseau · Dahl

Argument 2 · Parliamentarism Inverts Power

- Parties select candidates
- Voters ratify options
- Representatives obey party line
- Government dominates parliament
- Citizens lose command

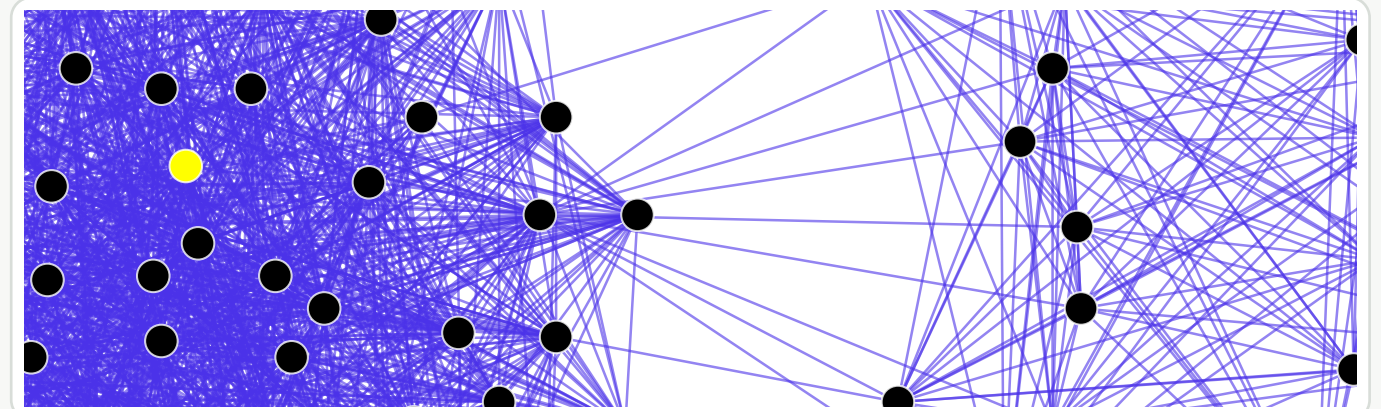


Argument 3 · Oligarchy Reproduces Itself

- Party machines
- Economic oligarchy
- Media influence
- State appointments
- Weak accountability

50/100

Corruption perception score · Greece



Accountability Breakdown

86/180

Press freedom rank · Greece

55.05

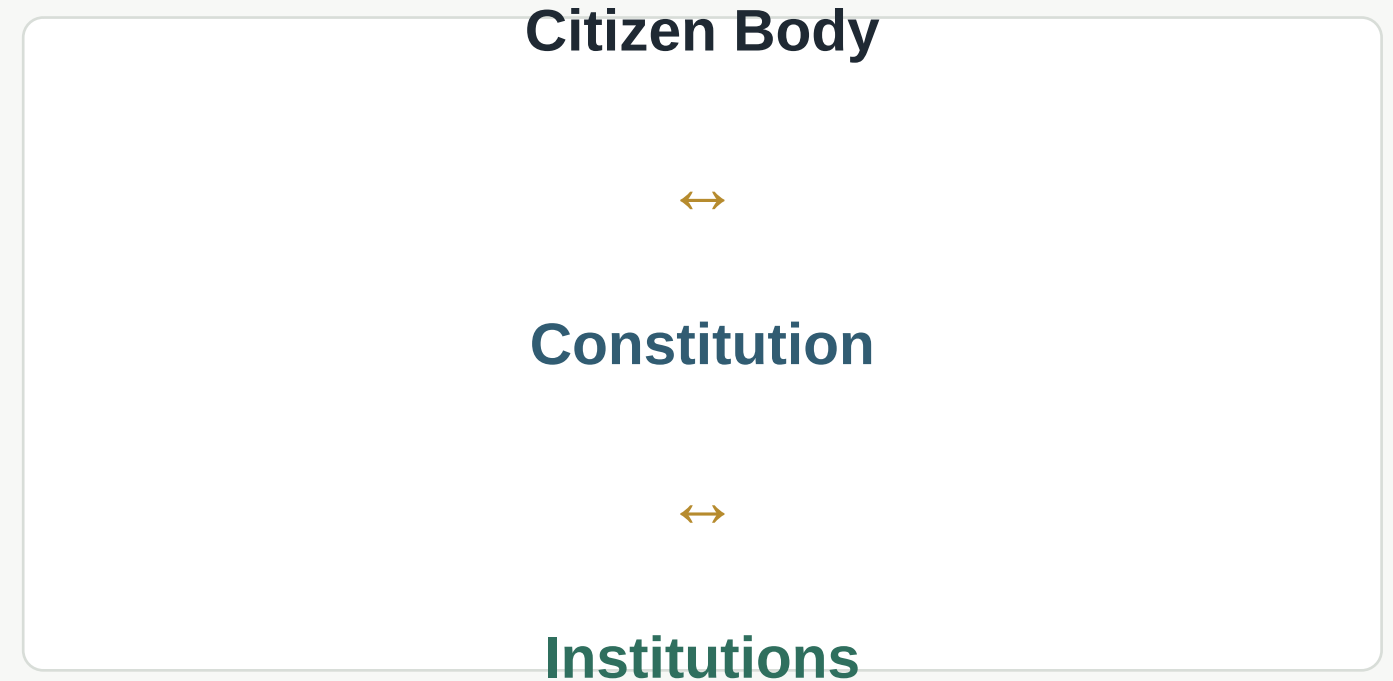
Press freedom score

- Institutional pressure
- Wiretapping concerns
- SLAPP pressure
- Information control
- Accountability deficit

Chart placeholder: Greece vs selected EU press freedom ranks

Satisfaction · Constitutional Makeover

- Citizen-initiated referenda
- Citizen legislative power
- Recall of officials
- Independent justice
- Transparent public finance
- Anti-corruption prosecution



Visualization · Two Political Orders

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting ritual
- Party command
- Elite bargaining
- Opaque decisions
- Managed citizens

Constitutional Democracy

- Citizen rule
- Direct mandate
- Recall
- Public audit
- Accountable institutions

Action · Demand Citizen Sovereignty

- Reject electoral minimalism
- Demand constitutional reform
- Support citizen referenda
- Support recall powers
- Organize beyond parties



Citizens must become an institution.

APA Bibliography

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